3.63
MILLION
Fixed as permanently moved/ absent

0.7
MILLION
Enrolled in multiple places

27,013
DELETIONS
Avg. per constituency



HULLABALOO IN THE HOUSE RJD leader Rabri Devi and party legislators at an anti-SIR protest in the Patna assembly, Jul. 24

ANI

but chaotic bureaucratic quickie.

To put this in perspective, the previous electoral roll published in January 2024 had deleted 1.6 million names while simultaneously adding 2.8 million new voters to the rolls. That exercise now appears extremely modest compared to the current purge. The sheer scale of the SIR deletions, four times larger than the previous revision, has turned it into a political flashpoint that threatens to reshape Bihar's electoral landscape just months before the state heads to polls.

THE MILLIONS MORE AT RISK

The real impact of the SIR will begin with who may yet be removed. The Election Commission has celebrated the fact of 80 per cent of the 72.4 million voters included in the draft roll submitting their supporting documents alongside their enumeration forms, the verification of which has just begun. But that also leaves out a chunky 20 per cent, approximately 14.5 million voters, for whom the clock is ticking with a September 1 deadline to submit documents that prove their eligibility. Political analyst and Swaraj Abhiyan founder Yogendra Yadav warns that voters who fail to submit documents—or fail the subsequent verification—are also at risk. The fall-off could swell the overall deletions well beyond the current 6.5 million.

THE ECI'S LIST OF 11 ACCEPTABLE DOCUMENTS HAS BECOME THE MOST CONTENTIOUS ISSUE

The controversy over acceptable documentation has emerged as the most contentious aspect of the entire exercise. The Election Commission's list of 11 acceptable documents conspicuously excludes Aadhaar, voter ID (issued by the ECI itself) and ration cards, the three most common forms of identification for Bihar's poor and marginalised populations. Instead, the ECI demands documents such as birth certificates, passports, matriculation certificates, land ownership papers, or pre-1987 government employment IDs, documents that are out of reach for many in Bihar, particularly those from rural areas.

Recognising that millions of voters lack conventional documentation,